Deployment Plan

Item	Details
Approach	Build in Power BI Desktop → publish to a Development workspace → test → promote to Production
Deployment objectives	Make the reports available to all departments, secure them with RLS, and keep them refreshed and recoverable
Expected outcomes	One trusted source of reports, timely access for users, fewer manual report requests, controlled access

Deployment Phases

Phase	Activity	Owner
1. Prepare	Finalise reports, check data and security roles	BI Developer
2. Deploy to Dev	Publish .pbix to the Development workspace	BI Developer
3. Test	Verify data, visuals, RLS and refresh	Tester / Analyst
4. Promote	Move approved content to Production	BI Administrator
5. Release	Assign users, set refresh, enable subscriptions and alerts	BI Administrator
6. Support	Monitor, collect feedback, fix issues	BI Team

Workspace Roles

Role	Can do	Typical person
Admin	Everything, including managing users, deleting the workspace and changing settings	BI Administrator
Contributor	Create and edit content and publish, but cannot manage users or share the workspace	BI Developer / Analyst
Member	Edit content, publish, share and add users with lower roles	Senior BI Developer
Viewer	View reports and dashboards only (RLS applies to this role)	CEO, managers, general users

Monitoring Matrix

Metric	What it shows	How it’s monitored	Frequency	Responsible
Access and permissions	Unauthorised or outdated access	Workspace access review	Quarterly	BI Administrator
Alerts and subscriptions	Whether notifications are delivered	Alert and subscription status	Weekly	BI Operations
Dashboard usage statistics	Views, viewers and popular reports	Usage metrics report in Power BI Service	Weekly	BI Analyst
Data quality	Missing or wrong values after refresh	Spot checks of KPI totals against the source	Weekly	BI Analyst
Dataset refresh status	Whether scheduled refreshes succeeded or failed	Refresh history in Power BI Service, with failure email notifications	Daily	BI Administrator
Report performance	How long visuals take to load	Performance Analyzer in Desktop, and user feedback	Before release, and monthly	BI Developer
User activity	Who accessed or changed what	Admin activity log / audit logs	Weekly	IT Security / BI Admin

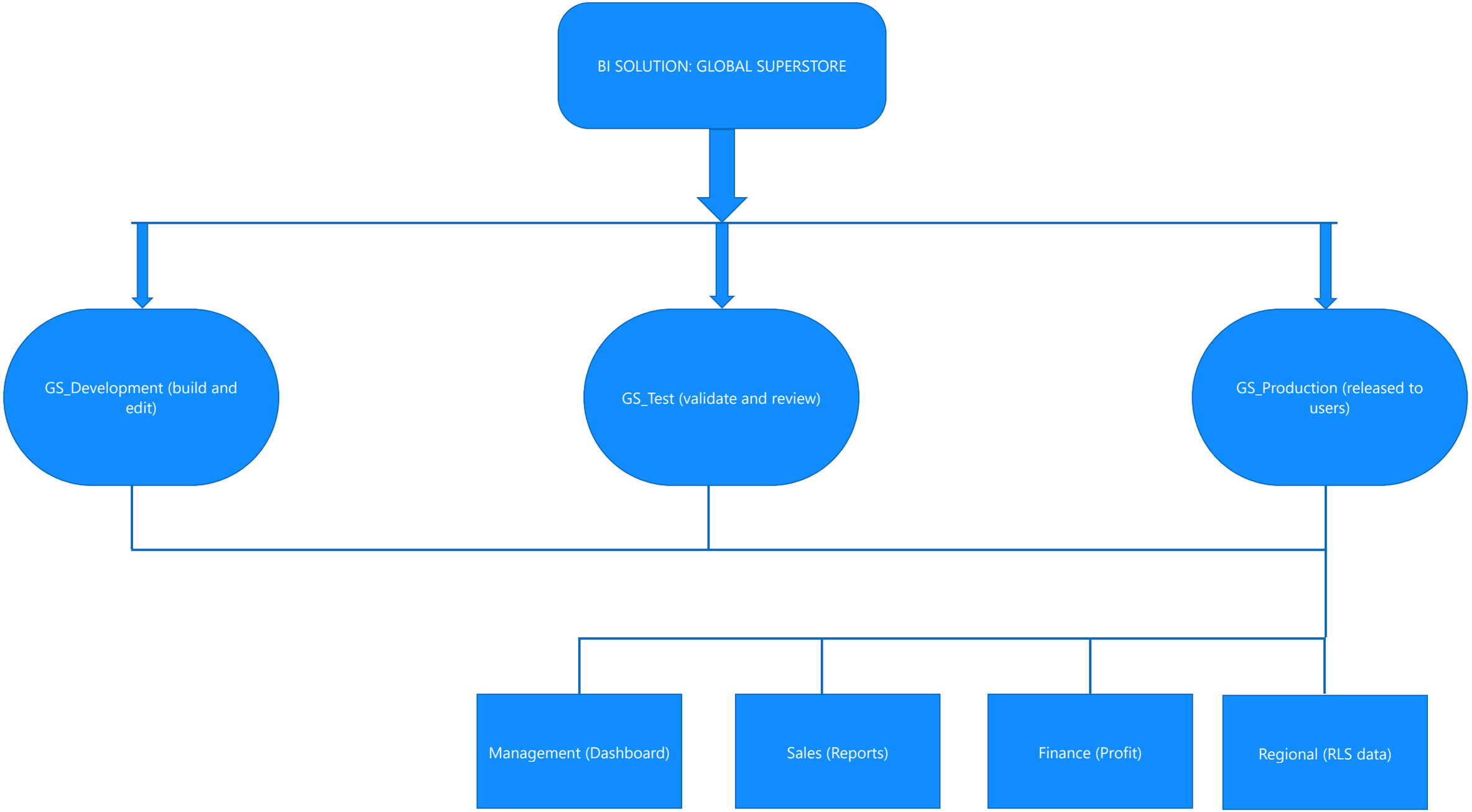
Backup_Schedule

Backup	Frequency	What is saved	Stored in	Retention	Owner
Dataset / source data backup	Daily	Source Excel and dataset files	Cloud storage (OneDrive / SharePoint)	[30 days]	BI Administrator
Report backup	Weekly	Latest .pbix of every report	Version-controlled folder	[12 weeks]	BI Developer
Workspace archive	Monthly	All .pbix files, security and refresh settings, documentation	Separate archive location	[12 months]	BI Administrator

Recovery Actions

Step	Action	Time
1	Confirm the deletion, check the workspace first, and inform the Administrator	[0–30 min]
2	Retrieve the latest .pbix from backup storage	[30–60 min]
3	Open it in Desktop, refresh the data and check visuals	[1–2 hours]
4	Republish to GS_Production, reconnect the data source, reset the refresh schedule	[2–3 hours]
5	Reassign sharing, subscriptions, alerts and RLS role members	[3–4 hours]
6	Validate KPI totals against the source and test access with a Viewer account	[4 hours]
7	Confirm with the executives that the dashboard is ready	before the meeting

When the executive dashboard was accidentally deleted, the BI Administrator would restore it from the most recent weekly backup of the report file, republish it to the production workspace, reconnect the data source and restore the access settings. The dashboard would be validated against the source data before the meeting, and a PDF snapshot from the monthly subscription would serve as a contingency, ensuring business continuity.


BI SOLUTION: GLOBAL SUPERSTORE
GS_Development (build and edit)
GS_Test (validate and review)
GS_Production (released to users)
Management (Dashboard)
Sales (Reports)
Finance (Profit)
Regional (RLS data)